

SEO Basics

Part of **Digital Marketing Essentials** · Estimated time: 40 min

Introduction

Search engine optimization is about helping a page rank well for the searches its intended audience is actually typing in — which means starting from how people search, not just what you want to say.

Core ideas

- Keyword research means finding the actual words and phrases people search, which are often more specific and more informal than the terms a business would use internally.
- On-page factors — a clear title tag, a descriptive meta description, headings that use relevant terms naturally — help search engines understand what a page is about.
- Technical factors matter too: page load speed and mobile-friendliness both affect ranking, independent of the content itself.
- Backlinks (other sites linking to yours) act as a trust signal — search engines treat them roughly like word-of-mouth recommendations.

Try it yourself

Pick a product or service and write three different search queries a real customer might type when looking for it. Search each one yourself and notice how differently the results are worded — that gap often reveals a content opportunity.

Further reading

- [Google Search — SEO Starter Guide](https://developers.google.com/search/docs/fundamentals/seo-starter-guide)

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- [Moz — Beginner's Guide to SEO](https://moz.com/beginners-guide-to-seo)

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